

Rehan A. Minhas

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Professional Summary

Accomplished laboratory scientist with over 15 years of experience in molecular biology, serology, and viral diagnostics. Proficient in PCR, ELISA, and cell culture techniques, with a strong focus on safety, quality assurance, and compliance with international standards. Skilled at optimizing laboratory processes, ensuring regulatory adherence, and delivering high-quality results. Dedicated to advancing virology and diagnostics through innovative problem-solving and a meticulous approach to laboratory management.

Employment History

Senior Laboratory Scientist

Anthony Nolan Laboratories, Hampstead. Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

- Worked in the Technical Services Team, conducting virological screening using Dynex instruments and ABO testing with Immunocor Echo, in compliance with UKAS standards.
- Led troubleshooting and optimization efforts to enhance laboratory processes, improving efficiency and quality.

Scientist

National Institute for Biological Standards & Controls (NIBSC), MHRA, South Mimms. Mar 2013 – Aug 2022

- Led WHO International Standardisation projects for Nucleic Acid Testing (NAT), coordinating international multicentre studies and publishing detailed reports.
- Produced CE-marked reagents and conducted molecular/serological batch release testing in compliance with ISO 13485 and GMP standards. Worked in Cat 3 laboratory suite.
- Performed stability potency testing, OCABR batch release screening, and viral diagnostics using advanced technologies like the Liaison XL Chemiluminescent ELISA and Roche Cobas 6800 RTqPCR systems.
- Conducted Western blot assays, dd-PCR quantification, and cell culture for virus propagation and inactivation.

Laboratory Manager

Smith's Detection, Bushey. Jan 2012 – Apr 2012

- Supported assay development for LATE PCR, validating molecular assays for pathogen detection.
- Managed laboratory operations, supplier coordination and staff training, in compliance with ISO 13485:2003.

Healthcare Scientist Practitioner

UK Health Security Agency, Colindale. Jan 2010 – Jan 2011

- Conducted molecular diagnostics for WHO and National Influenza Centre, focusing on RNA extraction and RTqPCR for respiratory virus detection.
- Provided diagnostic support for pandemic influenza, including swine flu and seasonal flu A/B testing.

Higher Science Technical Officer

NHS Blood Transplant, Histocompatibility & Immunogenetics, Colindale. Nov 2009 – Jan 2010

- Performed HLA typing using Luminex 200 and managed quality control to ensure compliance with GMP regulatory standards.

Biochemistry Technician

Bio Products Laboratory, Elstree. Mar 2008 – Jan 2009

- Conducted safety and potency testing using ELISA assays, in compliance with ISO 17025, GLP, GMP, and FDA regulations.

Experimental Officer

Covance Laboratories Ltd, Harrogate. May 2007 – Feb 2008

- Conducted RTqPCR for regulatory studies, ensuring compliance with GLP, GMP, and FDA standards.

Education & Qualifications

BSc (Honours) in Medical Biochemistry

University of Brunel, Uxbridge, London. 2001 – 2005

- Dissertation: DNA hypermethylation of hMLH1 promoter CpG and its exposure to the carcinogen PHIP.

Diploma in Professional Development

Department of Surgical Research, Northwick Park Hospital. 2003 – 2004

- Work Placement Project: A comparison of placental villous tree development in various study groups using histology and stereological microscopy.

Publications

- **Kempster, S.L., Minhas, R., Hockley, J.G., & Morris, C.L.** (2020). WHO International Standard for West Nile Virus RNA for NAT. WHO/BS/2020.2397.
- **Minhas, R., Govind, S., Kohli, A., Bleazard, T., Fritzsche, M., Matejtschuk, P., Hockley, J., & Morris, C.** (2020). WHO International Standard for Herpes Simplex Virus DNA for NAT. WHO/BS/2020.239.
- **Minhas, R., Adjei, E., Hockley, J., Rigsby, P., & Morris, C.** (2018). 2nd WHO International Standard for HIV-2 for NAT. WHO/BS/2018.2343.
- **Fryer, J.F., Minhas, R., Dougall, T., Rigsby, P., Morris, C.L., & Collaborative Study Group.** (2017). WHO International Standard for Hepatitis A Virus for NAT. WHO/BS/2017.2308.

Skills Profile

- **Laboratory Expertise:** Advanced expertise in molecular and serological assays, including qPCR, ELISA, virus propagation, and assay validation. Skilled in implementing automation tools, optimizing workflows, and troubleshooting diagnostic platforms.
- **Safety and Quality Management:** Proficient in ensuring laboratory safety compliance, managing risk assessments, and maintaining ISO and GMP standards. Experienced in quality assurance systems, audit preparation, and CAPA implementation.
- **Collaboration:** Adept at leading cross-functional teams in international research collaborations and complex laboratory projects. Skilled in mentoring junior scientists and fostering inclusive team environments.
- **Communication:** Strong technical writing skills for reports, publications, and SOPs. Experienced in delivering impactful presentations at conferences and to regulatory bodies.
- **IT Proficiency:** Proficient in LIMS, data analysis tools (Python, Excel), and automation workflows. Completed AI-Mediated Software Engineering bootcamp with experience in Python, ReactJS, cloud computing, and AI/ML concepts. Skilled in version control (GitHub) and collaborative project management using Jira.
- **Organisational Skills:** Highly skilled in project planning, resource allocation, and managing simultaneous workstreams in high-pressure laboratory settings.